

SENDKIT DOCS

Secondary domains, never your primary

Never send cold email from your company's main domain. Not once, not for a test batch. The risk is not hypothetical: it can put your own invoices in spam.

What actually happens

Cold email carries more spam risk than any other email your domain sends, simply because recipients have not opted in. Every domain has one shared reputation across every mailbox that uses it. Send cold outreach from mailboxes on your primary domain, and any spam complaints or blacklist hits attach to that same domain your finance and legal teams rely on for invoices, contracts, and support replies.

Damage your primary domain's reputation with cold email, and you can end up with your own company's invoices landing in a client's spam folder. That is a real, recurring failure mode. It is also one of the hardest to notice, because nobody tells you an invoice went unseen; you just eventually get a "did you get my payment" email and have to reconstruct what went wrong.

The fix: secondary domains

Buy lookalike domains that resemble your brand, variations, hyphens, alternate spellings, and run all cold outreach from those instead. If a secondary domain takes damage, your primary domain, your real business communication, is completely unaffected. The standard setup is 3 mailboxes per secondary domain, a number that keeps sending volume per domain low enough to protect reputation while you scale by adding more domains, not more mailboxes on the same one.

.com over cheap TLDs

Stick to .com for secondary domains. Cheaper alternatives like .info are tempting on price, but they get flagged on blacklists far faster. Senders running spray-and-pray tactics tend to cluster on cheap TLDs, and inbox providers have learned to treat those TLDs with more suspicion by default. A .com domain, sent from properly, tends to run clean for 3 to 6 months or longer; a .info domain used carelessly can burn out within a month. The few extra dollars for a .com secondary domain is cheap insurance against replacing burned infrastructure every few weeks.

WHY THIS WORKS ON SENDKIT

Every secondary domain and mailbox you buy through SendKit runs on the same isolated dedicated infrastructure as everything else in your workspace, so a damaged secondary domain never touches your primary domain's reputation or anyone else's.

Next step

Ready to set up sending domains the right way. Add mailboxes through one of SendKit's three routes: buy, import from InboxKit, or connect via SMTP.

Audit which domain your campaigns send from

Open each active campaign's sending settings and confirm it is running on a secondary domain, not your primary.

[Audit your sending domains](#)